

MUMBAI | Poster Warriors

After the Shiv Sena's recent drubbing in the Assembly polls, the party is hoping the legacy of Maratha warrior Chhatrapati Shivaji will rescue them. All attempts made by Shiv Sena CEO Uddhav Thackeray to modernise the party having boomeranged, the Sena has returned to their not-so-good old gimmicks. Having just attacked a media house, their next step is to stoke communal passions by plastering posters of Shivaji killing Mughal general Afzal Khan. In order to commemorate 350 years of the event and calling it Shiv Pratap Din, the Sena wants to celebrate by putting up the posters all over the city and state. The same posters caused riots in Sangli district during the Ganesh festival in September, so the Sena's ultimate motive is more than apparent. In this latest



SAINIKS WITH SHIVAJI'S CONTROVERSIAL POSTER

episode, the Mumbai Police refused to grant the party permission to install those posters in Mumbai. Had they been allowed to, the Sena would have ruffled many more feathers. *by Malini Bhupta*

Split Open

MEA spokesperson Vishnu Prakash has stuck to his job despite an elaborate exercise to replace him. Some of his colleagues aren't amused: after Director (External Publicity) Nagma Mallick quit, her successor Gopal Bagley has followed suit.

BHOPAL | The Half Notes

MADHYA PRADESH CHIEF MINISTER CHOUHAN

patis', husbands who ruled by proxy as their wives were elected sarpanchs. However, the reservation was challenged in the high court on the ground that by including SC/ST and OBC candidates, the total reservation would exceed 50 per cent, the ceiling prescribed by the Supreme Court in education and jobs. The petitioner, a leader of Congress's students wing NSUI, was expelled by the party as it didn't want to be seen as anti-women. While the high court dismissed the petition, those against the reservation for women have moved the Supreme Court. Prospective mayor-patis first have to clear the legal roadblock before taking command on behalf of their better halves. *by Ambresh Mishra*

When Shivraj Singh Chouhan reserved 33 per cent seats for women in panchayat bodies, he was making sure of harvesting the women votebank. And so were born 'sarpanch

KOLKATA |

Pay Slip

Theatre legend Sombhu Mitra's daughter Saonli Mitra, herself a veteran stage personality, is angry. Facing criticism that Mamata Banerjee has been paying her Rs 50,000 per month for working as chairperson of the Railways Heritage Committee, Saonli's response is, "The salary is nothing. Why should I not be paid for work? Being an artiste doesn't

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mean I can't be paid." Things are not going quite the way Banerjee had wanted with those intellectuals who worked for her electoral success. Artish Shuvaprasanna, on another railways committee, had a brush with singer-MP Kabir Suman. Singers Nachiketa and Pallav Kirtaniya demanded payment for railway road shows. It is not the camaraderie the railway minister dreamt from her comrades.

Abhijit Dasgupta